Dinkum

Google Sheets setup (Stage A), ad space, traffic tracking, and the roadmap for future iterations

Where things stand

- The Dinkum prototype covers Newtown, Enmore and Marrickville. It compares in-store, Uber Eats, DoorDash, direct and pickup prices, with memberships, deals, order confirmation, savings tracking and "Wrong price?" reports.
- Your data now lives in the **Dinkum data** Google Sheet. The site reads it directly.
- Sponsored placements and traffic tracking are built. Tracking switches on once you choose a service.
- The code is on GitHub in **apps/platepricer/** on branch **claude/loving-johnson-3js9mv**.

Part 1. The Google Sheet

I created the spreadsheet Dinkum data in your Google Drive. It has five tabs:

Tab	What goes in it
Guide	Explains every column, with an example for each.
restaurants	One row per restaurant: suburb, location, ratings, order links, fees, delivery radius, date checked.
menu	One row per item: in-store, Uber Eats, DoorDash and direct prices, dietary tags.
promotions	One row per deal: percent off, dollars off, free delivery or buy-one-get-one, with minimums and end dates.
sponsors	One row per paid placement (banner or featured card), with targeting and dates.

Date columns are formatted as plain text, so Google can't swap day and month. Type dates as **2026-11-03**.

Why I couldn't edit the sheet directly at first

Your account had the Google Drive and Google Calendar connectors, but not the **Google Sheets** connector. Drive can create and read files, but it can't edit cells or settings inside a sheet. **Update:** the Google Sheets connector has since become available in this session, so I can now fill in and update the sheet for you directly, keeping the same link.

What you need to do

1. **Share the sheet.** Share → General access → **Anyone with the link → Viewer**. Dinkum can't read it until you do. Everything in these tabs is public, so keep sponsor prices, contacts and invoices in a separate private sheet.
2. **Add a restaurant or two, then open Dinkum.** At the bottom of the restaurant list it should say "Prices from the Dinkum data sheet". If it still shows the demo, the connection needs fixing. This couldn't be tested from the build environment, because it can't reach Google.

3. **Optional: the report form.** Create a Google Form with six short-answer questions (Restaurant, Item, Where, Dinkum price, Price they saw, Note). Link it to the sheet and turn on email notifications for new responses. Then use *Get pre-filled link*, type the answers RESTAURANT, ITEM, WHERE, SHOWN, SEEN and NOTE, and send me the link. Reports then submit without the user leaving Dinkum, and you get an email for each one.

Tracking traffic

Tracking is built in but stays off until you choose a service:

- **Plausible** (recommended): simple, privacy-friendly, no cookie banner, about US$9 a month.
- **Google Analytics 4**: free, but uses cookies, so mention it in a privacy policy.

Send the site address (Plausible) or the GA4 measurement ID to switch it on. You'll see:

Measure	What it tells you
Pages	Landing, onboarding, browse, profile, and each restaurant page
Search	What people look for (e.g. "pad thai")
View restaurant / Add to cart	Which restaurants get attention
Order click	Which platform people choose, per restaurant: your pitch to restaurants about direct orders
Order confirmed	Real orders and rounded savings
Price report	Where your data needs re-checking
Sponsor impression / click	Views and clicks per ad: the numbers you show advertisers

Ad space

Each row in the **sponsors** tab creates a placement:

- **Banner**: a strip above the results with a headline, text, image and button. It links to the restaurant or any web address.
- **Featured**: a restaurant's card pinned first in the list, with a blue border. It only appears when the restaurant matches the person's filters.
- **Rules**: both are labelled "Sponsored", which matters under Australian Consumer Law. They never change prices, the "Cheapest" badges, or the order of the other restaurants.
- **Targeting**: by suburb and cuisine, with start and end dates. Set *active* to *no* to pause one. If several qualify, visitors rotate between them.
- **Selling it**: start with a flat weekly price per suburb, sold by invoice or a Stripe payment link. Charge per view or per click once traffic grows.
- An optional "Advertise on Dinkum" link can point to an enquiry form. Send me the link when you have one.

Part 2. Next steps for future iterations

In order. Each stage builds on the one before, and earlier stages stay useful if you pause.

1. Go live (Stage A) · this week

Get a real version in front of people, managed from the Google Sheet.

- Share the sheet and enter your first restaurants (I can now fill these in for you with the Sheets connector).
- **Put the site online.** It currently only exists as a file. Free static hosts such as Cloudflare Pages, Netlify or GitHub Pages work. Then buy a domain.
- Set up the report form, choose an analytics service, and add the "Advertise" link.
- Write a short privacy policy (addresses, location, analytics cookies).
- Check the DashPass and Uber One terms and the default fees, which are placeholders in the code.
- Run the name checks for "Dinkum": IP Australia trade marks, ASIC business names, .com.au domain, app stores.

Done when: the site is on a public address, reads the sheet, and you get report emails.

2. Pilot in three suburbs · weeks 2 to 6

Prove people use it and trust the prices.

- 20 to 30 restaurants across Newtown, Enmore and Marrickville. Re-check prices every one to two weeks, and record deals at the same time.
- Share with locals: community Facebook groups, uni groups, flyers at partner restaurants.
- Watch the numbers weekly: visits, searches, order clicks by platform, the share of orders confirmed, savings, reports.
- Approach restaurants with their own data: "we sent you X direct order clicks". Sign up your first sponsors.
- Collect feedback in person. What confuses people? What would make them come back?

Done when: regular repeat visitors, confirmed savings, and at least one restaurant keen to connect or sponsor.

3. Real backend (Stage B, Supabase) · after the pilot

Make running it fast for you, and let people keep their profile across devices.

- Database with restaurants, menu, **price history**, deals, sponsors, reports, users and orders. Import the Google Sheet.
- **Admin page**: pick a restaurant and see every item with four price boxes, plus "Checked today". Reports arrive in an inbox with Fixed and Dismiss buttons.
- Email notifications for new reports. Google and Apple sign-in, so savings and favourites follow people.
- Sponsor management and a report for each advertiser (views, clicks, dates).
- Google Places address autocomplete. Price-drop alerts on favourites.
- What I need: a Supabase account and project, plus its project URL and public key (never the "service role" key).

Done when: you manage everything from the admin page and the sheet is retired.

4. Connect restaurants and take orders · once restaurants say yes

Exact prices, and orders placed inside Dinkum.

- Start with restaurants on **Square**, whose API is open: prices sync automatically and show as "Live".
- Apply to the partner programs of menu-syncing companies (Deliverect, Otter, Chowly, Olo) to reach more restaurants.
- **Order in Dinkum**: payment by Stripe, sent into the restaurant's system. Delivery by the restaurant's own drivers, or by Uber Direct or DoorDash Drive (check Sydney availability and pricing).
- Orders placed in Dinkum count as "Verified savings" automatically.
- A restaurant dashboard: views, order clicks, direct orders, and how their markups compare with similar nearby restaurants.

Done when: the first direct orders flow through Dinkum.

5. Grow · later

More places, more reasons to come back.

- More suburbs (Stanmore, Erskineville, Dulwich Hill, then wider Sydney).
- Installable phone app (progressive web app first, then the app stores).
- Group orders and "my shout" splitting. Users report the personalised deals they're shown.
- Turn monetisation back on (on hold for now): direct-order fees, restaurant subscriptions, sponsored placements.

Done when: growth comes from word of mouth, not just your outreach.

Risks to keep in view

Risk	What to do
Uber Eats / DoorDash terms	Don't scrape or automate their apps. Get prices by checking manually, from restaurants, or through partners. Ask before using their logos.
Stale prices	Freshness labels, "Wrong price?" reports and regular re-checks. Restaurant connections fix it for good.
Personalised app deals	They can't be seen from outside. Keep the "check the total at checkout" reminder.
Privacy	Privacy policy before launch, stronger once accounts exist (Australian Privacy Act). Store data in a Sydney region.
Advertising	Always label it "Sponsored". Never let payment change prices, rankings or the "Cheapest" badges (Australian Consumer Law, and trust).
Name	Dinkum is a working name. Clear it before you spend money on branding.

Placeholders to check in the code (top of the script in index.html): MEMBERSHIPS, DEFAULT_FEES, REPORT_EMAIL / REPORT_FORM_PREFILL_URL, ANALYTICS, ADVERTISE_URL, APP_NAME.